



Assessment Policy

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1. PURPOSE

This policy sets out the principles, design criteria, and administration of assessments on the Chainsaw Courses eLearning platform. Assessment is central to the platform's purpose: to confirm that learners have achieved the theoretical knowledge required for safe chainsaw maintenance and cross-cutting before undertaking practical qualification training. This policy is aligned with IIRSM course approval standards.

2. ASSESSMENT DESIGN PRINCIPLES

- **Validity:** Each assessment item tests knowledge directly related to a stated learning outcome.
- **Reliability:** Questions are unambiguous and produce consistent results across all learners.
- **Fairness:** Assessment content is free from bias and does not unfairly disadvantage any group of learners.
- **Authenticity:** Assessment items reflect realistic scenarios encountered in chainsaw operation and maintenance.
- **Sufficiency:** The volume and range of assessment items is sufficient to provide a reliable picture of each learner's knowledge.

3. ASSESSMENT STRUCTURE

ASSESSMENT TYPE	DETAIL
Module Quizzes (×7)	Each of the 7 training modules concludes with a multiple-choice quiz. Quizzes are randomly drawn from a bank of questions to reduce repetition across attempts.
Mock Examination	A 45-question randomised examination covering the full course content. Simulates the standard of knowledge required for NPTC practical assessment.
Pass Threshold	80% correct answers required to pass each module quiz and the mock examination. This threshold reflects the safety-critical nature of chainsaw operation.
Retries	Unlimited retries are permitted for module quizzes. The mock examination may be retaken after a cooling-off period.
Sequential Locking	Module quizzes must be passed (≥80%) before the next module unlocks. Learners must also watch the full module video before the quiz becomes available.

4. MARKING AND RESULTS

All assessments are marked automatically by the Platform. The marking algorithm applies a simple correct/incorrect binary to each multiple-choice question. The percentage score is calculated as (correct answers ÷ total questions) × 100. Results are recorded in the learner's progress record and are available at any time from the Training Dashboard.

5. ASSESSMENT SECURITY

Assessment items are drawn randomly from a question bank of sufficient size to reduce the likelihood of learners memorising answer sequences. The Platform's device-locking mechanism ensures all assessments are completed by the registered learner. Dynamic watermarking on video content and the digital waiver provide additional security and evidence of authentic engagement with the material.

6. MALPRACTICE

Any attempt to circumvent the assessment process — including sharing answers, using unauthorised aids, or allowing a third party to complete assessments on the learner's behalf — constitutes malpractice and will result in immediate suspension of access without refund. Please refer to the Malpractice & Maladministration Policy for full details.

7. ADJUSTMENTS TO ASSESSMENT

Reasonable adjustments to the assessment process may be available for learners with a disability or learning difficulty. Please refer to the Reasonable Adjustments Policy. The 80% pass threshold cannot be adjusted as it is a fixed standard set within the IIRSM course approval framework.

8. REVIEW

Assessment items and marking criteria are reviewed annually as part of the Quality Management review cycle, and immediately following any material change in HSE/FISA guidance or IIRSM requirements.

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